

How to set up an AI Employee inside your organization

Public reference edition

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PREPARED FOR

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GitHub: github.com/robskar91

PREPARED BY

Robert Skarzynski

An AI Employee is a real Microsoft 365 user with an AI brain on an AI host (e.g. Cursor cloud agent or equivalent).

It is not a Teams store app. Colleagues find it by name or email, like a person.

Examples below use fictional [example.com](#) addresses · swap in your real ones when you deploy.

This kit names Microsoft 365, Entra, Teams, SharePoint, and Graph as products.

It does not include tenant IDs, app IDs, or passwords.

Public reference · No tenant IDs, app IDs, or passwords · No Global Admin on the AI Employee account

How to use this kit

Work through it in order. Phases A–F are the build. Appendix A is what you print. Appendix B is the one-pager you keep when something sticks.

Who this is for. IT leads who own Microsoft 365. Operations leads who will run the AI Employee day to day. An executive sponsor who will approve a licence seat.

Time. First useful internal AI Employee: usually 1–2 working days if a licence seat is already free. Graph automation (mail and Teams without clicking the web UI): budget another half day. Customer-facing AI Employee: add time for a human approval gate and reply templates. Do not skip that.

One rule for the whole kit

An AI Employee is a person. You create a real Microsoft 365 user. Colleagues chat with it like a colleague. It is not a Teams store app. People will not find it under Apps.

In this kit

#	Section	What you get
1	What’s an AI Employee	Person account, not a store app
2	What you need before day 1	Licence, admin, host, Entra app
3	Roles and permission sets	Alex, Jordan, Sam, Casey, Riley
4	AI Employee identity permission sets	Core Graph, shared mail, hard no
5	Step-by-step setup	Phases A–F
6	Coworker profile cards	Memory notes; card ≠ allowlist
7	Allowlists	Exact email; owner expands
8	How work arrives	Mail, Teams, owner chat; ack; passivity
9	Job queue / concurrency	Max 3, FIFO, AE- ids
10	Safety rails	Gates, templates, secrets, no Global Admin
11	Shared vs private files	SharePoint for humans; host for logs
12	Multi-employee squad (optional)	Lanes + standup format
13	Example blueprints	Ops, Support, Accounting
A	Printable checklist	One copy per AI Employee
B	Troubleshooting	One-pager

Example people in this kit

These names are teaching examples. Map Alex / Jordan / Sam (and the others) to your real people in the last column.

Example	Role in this kit	Your person
Alex	COO — owner / executive sponsor	
Jordan	M365 admin — IT Admin	

Example	Role in this kit	Your person
Sam	Support lead — AI Employee manager / lane owner	
Casey	Sales — allowlisted requester	
Riley	Ops — allowlisted requester	
Morgan	Controller — accounting blueprint only	

Example addresses in this kit

Mailbox: bot@example.com. Domain: example.com. Timezone: America/Chicago. Swap these for your real values when you deploy.

1. What's an AI Employee

An AI Employee is a person-account AI teammate — a real Microsoft 365 user with an AI brain, not a store app.

You create a real Microsoft 365 user, for example `bot@example.com`. The AI Employee signs in as that person. It gets a mailbox, Teams chat, and — if you grant it — SharePoint files. An AI host (e.g. Cursor cloud agent or equivalent) runs the brain. The Microsoft account is the hands.

What it is

- A licensed Microsoft 365 user, searchable by display name or email.
- A teammate with a lane (the work it owns) and an allowlist (who may assign work).
- Optional Graph automation so it can poll mail and chat on a schedule.

What it is not

- A Teams store app. People will not find it under Apps.
- A website chat widget.
- A Global Admin.
- A shared mailbox by itself. It may watch shared mailboxes. It still needs its own user.

How people talk to it

In Teams: New chat. Search the display name (example: “Ops AI Employee”) or the email `bot@example.com` Same as messaging a colleague.

Tell staff this on day one

The most common support ticket is “I can’t find the AI Employee under Apps.” It is a person. Search people, not Apps.

Words this kit uses

Every term below gets a one-line definition. No jargon without one.

Term	Meaning
UPN	User Principal Name. The sign-in email, e.g. <code>bot@example.com</code>
Entra	Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure AD). Where you create the user and the app.
Graph	Microsoft Graph. The API the AI Employee uses to read and send mail, chat, and files.
MSAL	Microsoft Authentication Library. Stores a login token so routines can run unattended.
Token cache	The file on disk that holds that token. One cache per UPN. Never share.
Lane	The work this AI Employee owns, and the work it must not touch.
Allowlist	The short list of employees allowed to assign solo work to the AI Employee.
Approval gate	A named human must say yes before the AI Employee sends a customer-facing message.
Delegated permission	Graph access as the signed-in user. Only what that user could do in the web UI.
SKU	The Microsoft 365 licence product. Example: Business Standard.
Shared mailbox	An unlicensed mailbox several people (or the AI Employee) can open. Not an M365 Group.
M365 Group	A group with a mailbox, a Team, and a SharePoint site. Permissions differ.

Term	Meaning
Device-code login	A code shown on the host. A human completes sign-in and MFA in a browser.
Coworker profile card	Durable note about one person (email, prefs, threads). Not permission to assign work.
Job allowlist	Exact email list of who may assign solo work. Owner expands it.
AE- id	Job id pattern AE-YYYYMMDD-NNN. Optional in owner chat; useful in Teams/mail.
Job queue	Cap on substantial in-flight work (typical max 3), FIFO; quick asks unlimited.
Private employee state	Host folder for logs, queues, caches. Humans use SharePoint / Word instead.

2. What you need before day 1

Four prerequisites. Do not create the user until each exists. A greyed-out licence on the create-user form is not a bug — it means inventory is empty or partner-managed.

2.1 A licence seat

Typical SKU: Microsoft 365 Business Standard (or E3 / E5 equivalent). Mail-only SKUs are not enough.

The AI Employee needs:

- Exchange mailbox, including the ability to mail people outside the company.
- Teams.
- SharePoint / OneDrive if it will create or edit files.

If licences are bought through a partner (Pax8 or similar), you often cannot buy a seat inside the Microsoft 365 admin centre. Order a seat, or reassign an unused one, before create day. Write down who lost the seat if you reassign.

2.2 An admin who can click

You need a human with rights to:

- Create a user in Entra / Microsoft 365 admin.
- Assign a licence.
- Grant mailbox permissions (Exchange admin).
- Register or reuse an Entra app, and grant admin consent.

That person is the IT Admin (example: Jordan). The AI Employee account itself does not get these rights.

2.3 An AI host

The AI Employee's brain runs on an AI host (for example a Cursor cloud agent, or equivalent) that can:

- Stay signed in.
- Run scheduled routines (mail intake, Teams intake).
- Keep a durable disk file for the token cache.
- Open Outlook on the web and Teams on the web as a fallback.

Confirm the host can reach `login.microsoftonline.com` and `graph.microsoft.com`.

Office-IP egress later

If you later need the AI Employee's traffic to look like it comes from an office IP, provision the host's egress tunnel first. Do not fight a greyed-out "route through this desktop" toggle.

2.4 An Entra app (public client)

Graph login uses a public-client app registration in your tenant.

- Delegated permissions only in this kit (the AI Employee acts as the user).
- Device-code flow allowed, so a human can complete MFA.
- Admin consent for the scopes in section 4.

You may reuse one org-wide app for every AI Employee. You must not reuse token caches.

Day-1 readiness

Need	Who owns it (example)	Ready
Licence seat (Business Standard or equivalent)	Licence owner	
Entra / Microsoft 365 admin	Jordan — M365 admin	
Exchange admin (mailbox permissions)	Jordan — M365 admin	
AI host with durable disk (e.g. Cursor cloud agent)	IT / ops	
Entra public-client app + admin consent	Jordan — M365 admin	
Display name + UPN chosen	Alex — COO	
Human manager named	Alex — COO	
Allowlist draft	Sam — Support lead	
Customer-facing? Yes/No written down	Alex — COO	

Tick the Ready column on paper when each row is true. Do not create the user until every row is ticked.

3. Roles and permission sets

These are human roles. The AI Employee's own Graph scopes are in section 4. Use the example employees as teaching names · map them to your real staff.

3.1 Role map

Role	Example	Typical title	What this role is for
Owner / Executive sponsor	Alex	COO	Pays for the seat. Sets policy. Names the human manager. Can stop the project.
IT Admin	Jordan	M365 admin	Creates the user, licence, mailbox rights, and Entra consent. Not the day-to-day operator.
AI Employee manager / lane owner	Sam	Support lead	Named in the Entra manager field. Owns tone, templates, and the approval gate.
Allowlisted employee	Casey	Sales	May assign in-lane work in Teams or mail. Cannot change Graph scopes.
Allowlisted employee	Riley	Ops	Same as Casey, for operations asks.
Everyone else	—	—	May see the AI Employee in the directory. The employee stays silent unless your policy says otherwise.

You can add more allowlisted people later. Keep the first list short.

3.2 Owner / Executive sponsor — Alex (COO)

Can

- Approve the licence spend or seat reassignment.
- Choose the lane in one sentence (“internal ops assistant,” “customer support drafts,” “accounting helper”).
- Name the AI Employee manager.
- Expand or shrink the allowlist.
- Require an approval gate for customer-facing mail.

- Pause or delete the AI Employee.

Cannot

- Skip MFA or first-login hygiene.
- Paste temp passwords into chat, email, or tickets.
- Ask the AI Employee to bypass its own lane (“just email this customer this once”) without changing written policy.

3.3 IT Admin — Jordan (M365 admin)

Can

- Create the Entra / Microsoft 365 user.
- Assign or reassigned the licence. Document who lost a seat.
- Set the manager field.
- Grant shared-mailbox Full Access and Send As, or M365 Group member/owner + Send As.
- Register or reuse the Entra public-client app.
- Admin-consent Graph scopes.
- Rotate the temp password and confirm MFA.
- Disable the account if something goes wrong.

Cannot

- Assign the AI Employee Global Admin (hard no — see section 4.4).
- Operate the AI Employee’s lane day to day (that is Sam, Casey, Riley).
- Approve customer replies (that is Sam).
- Share or copy token cache files between UPNs.

3.4 AI Employee manager / lane owner — Sam (Support lead)

Can

- Be listed as manager on the AI Employee user.
- Approve or reject customer-facing sends.
- Edit the tone card and mark templates DRAFT → APPROVED.
- Decide which shared mailboxes and groups the AI Employee watches.
- Escalate edge cases to Alex.
- Ask Jordan to add or remove an allowlisted person.

Cannot

- Grant Graph scopes or buy licences.
- Make the AI Employee a Global Admin.
- Expand Graph into HR or payroll sites without a written blueprint.
- Skip the approval gate while templates are still DRAFT.

3.5 Allowlisted employees — Casey (Sales) and Riley (Ops)

Can

- Open a Teams chat with the AI Employee by searching the person name or email.
- Assign in-lane work (status, drafts, file finds, internal notes).
- Get a short “got it” while the AI Employee works, then an answer.
- Ask Sam to put a new person on the allowlist.

Cannot

- Instruct the AI Employee to email customers unless Sam's gate (or an APPROVED template) allows it.
- Share passwords, MFA codes, or token files with the AI Employee in chat.
- Change licences, Graph scopes, or the manager field.
- Treat “everyone in the company directory” as allowlisted. They are not.

3.6 Quick comparison

Action	Alex owner	Jordan IT	Sam manager	Casey / Riley	AI Employee account
Buy / reassign licence	Approve	Do it	No	No	No
Create Entra user	No	Do it	No	No	—
Consent Graph scopes	Policy yes	Do it	Request	No	No
Approve customer email	Policy	No	Yes	No	No, until gate
Assign in-lane work	Yes	Rarely	Yes	Yes	Receives it
Global Admin	Don't	Human only if required	No	No	Never
HR / payroll sites	Policy	Conditional access	No unless blueprint	No	No unless blueprint

4. AI Employee identity permission sets

The AI Employee account is a normal licensed user. It is never Global Admin. It is never Privileged Role Administrator. It is never Exchange Administrator.

Delegated Graph access means: if the user could not do it in Outlook or Teams on the web, the API cannot do it either. That is the point.

4.1 Core Graph scopes (delegated)

These are what the Entra app requests on behalf of `bot@example.com`

Scope	Plain English	Core?
User.Read	Know who it signed in as.	Yes
Mail.ReadWrite	Read, draft, and file mail in its own mailbox.	Yes
Mail.Send	Send from its own mailbox.	Yes
Chat.ReadWrite	Read and send Teams chats.	Yes
Sites.ReadWrite.All	Read and write SharePoint sites this user can already access.	Yes
Files.ReadWrite.All	Read and write files this user can already access.	Yes
offline_access	Keep a refresh token so scheduled routines can run.	Yes

“All” does not mean the whole tenant

In a delegated Sites/Files scope, “All” means “all sites this user is already allowed to use.” Still keep a written site allow-list (section 6).

4.2 Shared mailbox and M365 Group patterns

Inspect the mailbox type before you grant anything. The admin centre labels look similar. The buttons are not.

Classic shared mailbox

Often an unlicensed, disabled user object.

1. In Exchange admin: grant the AI Employee Full Access and Send As.
2. Wait 5–15 minutes.
3. Confirm the mailbox appears in Outlook on the web for `bot@example.com`
4. If you want Graph (not just the web UI) to read or send as that mailbox, add the optional shared-mail scopes in 4.3.

Microsoft 365 Group

Group mailbox + Team + SharePoint site.

1. Add the AI Employee as a member.
2. Add as owner only if it must manage membership. Most AI Employees do not need that.
3. Grant Send As on the group.
4. Do not hunt for “Full Access.” That control is for shared mailboxes, not groups.

Distribution list

The AI Employee can receive mail if it is a member. Sending as the DL is awkward. Prefer a shared mailbox or an M365 Group for any AI Employee that must send.

Lesson

“Full Access failed” often means you are staring at a Group, not a shared mailbox. Inspect type first.

4.3 Optional scopes

Grant only if the lane needs them. Admin-consent each one. Write the reason next to it.

Scope	When you need it
Mail.Read.Shared	Read mail in shared mailboxes via Graph.
Mail.ReadWrite.Shared	File or draft in shared mailboxes via Graph.
Mail.Send.Shared	Send as a shared mailbox via Graph.
Group.Read.All	Discover groups and membership. Prefer this over Directory.Read.All.
Sites.Read.All	Read-only SharePoint if the AI Employee must never write.
Calendars.ReadWrite	Only if the AI Employee books rooms or staff calendars.

Start without the optional set. Add after a smoke test proves the web UI path works.

4.4 Hard no — the AI Employee account

Never on the AI Employee user

No Global Admin. No Privileged Identity Management standing admin. No Exchange Administrator, User Administrator, or Application Administrator. No application (app-only) Graph permissions in this kit. No Directory.ReadWrite.All. No sharing of the MSAL token cache across UPNs.

- No standing access to HR, payroll, benefits, or personal finance sites unless the blueprint is Accounting and the controller named the sites in writing.
- Jordan (the human IT Admin) may hold admin roles. The AI Employee user must not.

5. Step-by-step setup (phases A–F)

Copy this for every new AI Employee. One UPN per lane. Do not run support, ops, and accounting on the same mailbox.

Phase A — Decide

Before anyone opens the admin centre, write these eight lines down. Alex signs them.

1. Display name — what colleagues will search in Teams. Example: Ops AI Employee, or Customer Support Team.
2. UPN / mailbox — `bot@example.com`
3. Lane — one sentence it owns, one sentence it does not.
4. Human manager — Sam (example). This goes in the Entra manager field.
5. Customer-facing? If yes: approval gate + templates. Do not skip.
6. Shared mailboxes / groups to watch — e.g. `info@example.com` `ops@example.com`
7. Other systems — CRM, product dashboard, accounting tool? Separate grants. Not Graph.
8. Squad — will it sit in a standup channel with other AI Employees? Keep squads tight.

Phase B — Licence and Entra

1. Confirm a Business Standard (or required) seat is available.
2. If partner-managed inventory: order or reassign before you open the create-user form.
3. Create the user in Entra / Microsoft 365 admin. Set display name and UPN.
4. Assign the licence. Wait until Exchange shows a mailbox.
5. Set the manager field to the human lane owner (Sam in the example).
6. Set a temp password. Hand it to the host operator on screen only. Never paste it into chat, email, a ticket body, or git.
7. First sign-in: force password change and enrol MFA.
8. Wipe any password file after MFA is confirmed.

Phase C — Mail and Teams

1. Sign into Outlook on the web and Teams on the web as the new UPN. This proves the identity works.
2. Treat desktop Teams clients on Linux hosts as optional. They crash. Web or Graph is the real path.
3. Grant shared mailbox / group access using section 4.2. Inspect type first.
4. Confirm the AI Employee can see those inboxes (wait 5–15 minutes).
5. Send a test mail to the owner only. Reply in a test Teams chat with the owner.
6. Do not announce the AI Employee to the whole company yet.

Phase D — Graph

1. Confirm the Entra public-client app is usable by this UPN (org-wide delegated).
2. Create a dedicated MSAL cache file for this UPN. Name it after the slug, for example `msal-token-cache-bot.bin`. Never reuse another AI Employee's cache.
3. Device-code login as `bot@example.com` A human completes MFA.
4. Helper scripts must take cache path and UPN as arguments. Do not hard-code the email.
5. Smoke tests, in this order: GET /me returns this UPN; list mail; send a test message to the owner only; send a test Teams chat; open a shared mailbox if granted.
6. Point intake routines at Graph. Keep Outlook / Teams on the web as fallback.

Lesson — Graph vs browser

An AI Employee that only uses the web UI can work. It is not Graph-parity. Budget a Graph login day if it will poll or send at volume. Do not call the web path “done” if you want automation.

Phase E — AI host agent and routines

1. Create the agent. Name, description, and title must include: lane, UPN, manager, policy.
2. Add to a squad channel only if it must coordinate with other AI Employees. Do not drop every helper into every room.
3. Routines: Outlook intake + Teams intake. Weekday business hours in America/Chicago
4. Encode: stay silent if nothing is new; in large groups (more than three people including the AI Employee) reply only when addressed; honour the approval gate; honour the allowlist; point at the tone card if customer-facing.
5. A lead human (or a lead AI Employee, if you run a squad) audits the routine prompts after create.

Phase F — Docs

1. A job folder with a brief: who, UPN, lane, manager, status.
2. A setup file on the owner’s desktop.
3. Tone card + reply templates if customer-facing. Mark them DRAFT until Sam approves.
4. Update the org map so humans know how to find the AI Employee.
5. Tell staff: search the person name or email, not Apps.
6. Create empty coworkers/ + index, job-allowlist.json (Alex’s emails only at first), and jobs-queue.json.
7. Decide SharePoint sites for human docs vs the host folder for private employee state (section 11).

What success looks like

Alex (or Sam) can open Teams → New chat → find the AI Employee by name. A short “got it” arrives on a real ask. Intake stays silent when nothing is new. No Global Admin on the employee account. Customer-facing lanes never send without Sam’s gate (or an APPROVED template).

Suggested job folder

```
jobs/AE-YYYYMMDD-NNN/
brief.md
*-Setup.md
tone-card.md # if customer-facing
templates/ # DRAFT → APPROVED
routine-audit-*.md
```

Graph helpers should be parameterized (UPN + cache path). Never hard-code one mailbox into a shared script. Name caches msal-token-cache-bot.bin, msal-token-cache-support.bin, and so on.

6. Coworker profile cards

A coworker profile card is a short, durable note about one person the AI Employee works with. It lives on the AI host (example: `coworkers/<slug>.md`) with an index file (`coworkers.md`).

Card ≠ allowlist

Card = memory. Allowlist = permission. A coworker card helps the AI Employee remember how to work with Casey or Riley. It does not let them assign solo work. Only the allowlist (section 7) does that — exact email, owner expands.

What a card stores

Field	What it is	Example
Name + slug	File name and heading	casey-sales.md → Casey
Email	Exact work email	casey@example.com
Role	How they show up at work	Sales — quotes and follow-ups
How we work	Channels that matter	Teams 1:1 for asks; owner chat for policy
Prefs	Tone and habits	Lead with the answer; one bubble on Teams
Allowlist?	Mirror of the allowlist row (info only)	Yes — owner added 2026-09-10
Chat ids	Teams chat labels the AI Employee watches	casey_and_alex
Open threads	Live work tied to job ids	AE-20260914-004 — quote pack draft
Notes / recent	Sticky facts worth keeping	Prefers PDF over long chat dumps

Conversation history stays per Teams chat. Do not paste one chat's thread into another person's card as if it were shared memory.

When to update a card

Event	Update?
New email, nickname, or title	Yes
New preference (“don’t dig my Uber”)	Yes
Open thread started or closed	Yes — tie to an AE- id when you have one
One-off FAQ with no sticky fact	No
Someone asks to be allowlisted	Update the allowlist first; card comes after

Example card (fictional)

Casey

- Email: casey@example.com
- Role: Sales
- How we work: Teams 1:1 for status; mail for customer drafts (Sam gate)
- Prefs: Lead with the answer; short bubbles; no out-of-the-blue catch-ups
- Allowlist: Yes (Alex expanded 2026-09-10)
- Chat: casey_and_bot (Teams 1:1)
- Open threads: AE-20260914-004 — draft quote for Contoso (waiting Sam)
- Notes: Prefers SharePoint links over Doc.aspx dumps.

Card vs allowlist

	Coworker card	Job allowlist
Purpose	Memory and tone	Who may assign solo work
Stored as	Markdown card + index	Exact-email JSON (or equivalent)
Who expands it	AI Employee updates facts; humans own prefs	Owner (Alex) expands emails
If missing	AI Employee may still know them from chat	AI Employee must not take solo jobs from them
Common mistake	“On a card = allowlisted”	Wrong — card is not the gate

Remember: card ≠ allowlist

Riley on a card ≠ Riley on the allowlist. Alex must put `riley@example.com` on the allowlist file before Riley can assign solo work.

7. Allowlists

The job allowlist is the short list of people allowed to assign solo work to the AI Employee. Exact email match only. No wildcards. No “sounds like Casey.”

Who can request jobs

Person	On allowlist?	What the AI Employee does
Alex (owner)	Yes	Full access to assign in-lane work
Sam (manager)	Yes	Assigns work; owns customer gate
Casey / Riley	Yes (once added)	In-lane asks in Teams or mail
Jordan (IT)	Optional	Usually rare day-to-day asks
Random coworker in the directory	No	“Ask Alex or Sam to add you,” or silence by policy
Display name only (“Casey from Sales”)	No match	Never infer email from a display name

Exact-email rule

1. Compare the sender’s email (mail From, or Teams user’s mail) to the allowlist byte-for-byte (normalize case if your org is case-insensitive; still no fuzzy name match).
2. If the email is not listed → do not start a solo job.
3. Never invent an allowlist entry because someone asked nicely in chat.
4. A coworker card that says “Allowlist: Yes” is a mirror for humans. The file is the gate.

How the owner adds someone

1. Alex (or Sam, if Alex delegated) decides the person is in-lane and trusted.
2. Add the exact email to `job-allowlist.json` (or equivalent), e.g. `casey@example.com`
3. Optionally create or update the coworker card.
4. Tell Casey: Teams → New chat → search the AI Employee person name `obot@example.com`
5. The AI Employee does not add Casey because Casey DMed “please add me.”

Example allowlist rows

Name	Email	Notes
Alex (COO)	alex@example.com	Owner
Sam (Support lead)	sam@example.com	AI Employee manager
Casey (Sales)	casey@example.com	Allowlisted
Riley (Ops)	riley@example.com	Allowlisted
Jordan (M365 admin)	jordan@example.com	IT — rare day-to-day asks

The AI Employee does not add people

Someone asking nicely in chat is not an allowlist change. Alex or Sam writes the new email down.

8. How work arrives

Work reaches the AI Employee on three paths. Encode the same ack and passivity rules on every path.

Channels

Channel	Who uses it	Typical ask	Ack?
Email (employee mailbox or watched shared mailbox)	Allowlisted humans; customers if support lane	Status, draft, file find	Yes if dig > ~60s
Teams (1:1 or small group ≤3 incl. AI Employee)	Allowlisted humans	Same as email, faster	Yes if dig > ~60s
Owner chat (AI host with Alex)	Owner	Setup, policy, priority	Light process; AE- ids optional
Large Teams group (>3 incl. AI Employee)	Mixed	Only when clearly addressed	Passive otherwise

Prefer Graph, keep web as fallback

1. Graph first (MSAL) to list and send mail / Teams — draft fully, then one send.
2. Fallback: Outlook on the web / Teams on the web if Graph auth fails. Report the blocker once to Alex or Jordan.
3. Do not rely on desktop Teams clients on thin Linux hosts.
4. One UPN = one MSAL cache. Never share caches across AI Employees.

Ack rules (no silent long digs)

Situation	What the AI Employee does
True one-bubble FAQ	Answer in one message. No separate ack.
Dig will take more than ~60 seconds	First bubble: short “Got it — checking ...”. Then dig. Second bubble: answer or checkpoint.
Already at concurrency cap	Queued ack is the immediate ack (say you’re queued).
Nothing new on an intake pass	Stay silent. Silence is success.
Ask older than ~2 hours and thread moved on	Stay silent unless they re-ask or @mention.

Large-group passivity

If a Teams chat has more than three participants including the AI Employee: stay passive. Reply only when clearly addressed (@mention, AI Employee display name, employee email, or an unambiguous ask to the AI Employee). Do not answer every human-to-human message.

Example

Dev-style room with Alex, Casey, Riley, Jordan, and the AI Employee → it speaks only when someone says “Ops AI Employee, can you pull last week’s ops status?”

Each Teams chat is a separate context. Never answer using another chat’s thread.

9. Job queue and concurrency

Heavy work is capped so one dig does not starve everyone else. Quick asks stay unlimited.

Rule	Typical value	Plain English
Max substantial jobs working	3	SharePoint digs, multi-file research, multi-step analysis
Quick replies per intake pass	Unlimited	One-bubble FAQ / yes-no / pointer
Order	FIFO by queue time	Oldest queued substantial job starts next, unless Alex reprioritizes
Time-box per wake	~12–15 minutes	Then checkpoint and yield
Job id	AE-YYYYMMDD-NNN	Useful in Teams/mail; optional in owner chat

Job states

State	Meaning
queued	Acknowledged; waiting for a substantial slot
working	In progress (counts toward the cap of 3)
waiting	Blocked on a human (Alex, Sam, or requester)
done / rejected	Finished or declined

Track open substantial jobs in a small queue file on the host (example: `jobs-queue.json`) plus a folder per job under `jobs/AE-.../`.

Example flow (fictional)

- Casey asks for a multi-site file find → AI Employee sends “Got it — searching Sales and Ops now,” creates AE-20260914-004, status working.
- Riley asks for another dig while three jobs are already working → AI Employee sends “Queued as AE-20260914-005 — I’ll start when a slot frees.”
- Alex in owner chat says “pause 005, do the Contoso pack first” → owner may reorder; still checkpoint cleanly.

Owner chat vs Teams

Owner chat: light process; AE- ids optional. Teams / mail: use AE- ids on substantial work. Never leave an allowlisted Teams/mail ask with zero activity for a full poll cycle while you research.

10. Safety rails

Put these in the agent instructions, not only in this PDF. Non-negotiable.

Approval gates and templates

Stage	Customer / external send	Internal teammate
Templates still DRAFT	Sam must approve every outbound	No customer gate
Templates APPROVED	APPROVED templates may send; edge cases still escalate	No customer gate
Edge case forever	Refunds, legal, pricing, “just this once”	Escalate; do not invent policy

Graduate: every outbound → non-template only → edge cases forever. No “full auto on all customer mail” step in this kit.

Template send vs escalate

AI Employee sees	Action
Exact APPROVED template fit	May send (support lane)
Close but not exact	Draft + ask Sam
Refund / legal / pricing / angry escalation	Escalate to Sam. Do not send.
Internal allowlisted ask	Answer in lane; no Sam gate

Secrets

- Temp passwords, recovery codes, client secrets, card CWs: screen-only.
- Never paste secrets into chat, tickets, git, or SharePoint “for convenience.”
- Wipe handoff files after MFA.
- Job folders may hold a pointer that a secret exists; do not commit the secret into the kit or git.

No Global Admin on the AI Employee

Never Global Admin, Exchange Admin, User Admin, or Application Admin. No app-only Graph in this kit. No Directory.ReadWrite.All. One MSAL cache per UPN — mixing caches is a security incident. Soft-deny HR, payroll, benefits, and personal finance sites unless the blueprint names them in writing.

Ten rails (checklist form)

1. Approval gate

Customer-facing mail until templates are APPROVED.

2. Allowlist

Exact email; owner expands.

3. Secrets are screen-only

Wipe handoff files after MFA.

4. One cache per UPN

Mixing caches is an incident.

5. Least privilege

User, not admin. No Global Admin.

6. Stay in lane

Ops AI Employee ≠ customer quotes; accounting ≠ password resets.

7. No silent long work

Ack if dig > ~60s.

8. Large-group passivity

Reply when addressed; do not take over.

9. Site allow / deny

Written list; soft-deny HR/payroll unless blueprint.

10. Document as you go

If it is not written down, the next admin cannot run it.

11. Shared vs private files

Humans and the AI Employee do not share one dump folder. Split human docs from private employee state.

Kind	Where it lives	Who reads it	Examples
Human-facing docs	SharePoint (allowed sites)	People + AI Employee (if granted)	Process guides; CS templates Sam edits
Human-facing Word / PDF	SharePoint or OneDrive links	People	Customer-facing CS docs in Word
Private employee state	Host folder	AI Employee (+ owner on host)	Queue, intake logs, MSAL caches, coworker cards
Job artifacts for humans	SharePoint or owner desktop	People	Setup kit PDF; brief Sam should see
Secrets / token caches	Host only, locked down	AI Employee operator	msal-token-cache-bot.bin — never email

Rules of thumb

1. If a human must edit it next week → put it on SharePoint (or send a Word/PDF), not only on the AI Employee disk.
2. If it is an intake log, queue, or token → keep it in private employee state. Do not publish caches to SharePoint.
3. Keep a written site allow-list. Soft-deny HR / payroll / finance name patterns unless Morgan's accounting blueprint says otherwise.
4. Prefer clean SharePoint links in Teams replies. Avoid raw Doc.aspx dumps when a library link will do.
5. Customer Support docs Sam owns: Word on SharePoint, status DRAFT → APPROVED, then the AI Employee may use them.

Example layout

```
SharePoint /sites/[ops] # human docs, templates Sam edits
Host private state/
coworkers/ # profile cards
coworkers.md # index
job-allowlist.json # exact emails
jobs-queue.json # concurrency
jobs/AE-YYYYMMDD-NNN/ # per-job brief + drafts
msal-token-cache-bot.bin # this UPN only
outlook-processed.json # intake dedup
teams-*-processed.json
```

12. Optional — multi-employee squad

Use this only if you run more than one AI Employee. Keep squads tight.

Lanes (example)

AI Employee	UPN (example)	Lane	Human manager
Lead / Ops (AI Employee)	bot@example.com	Internal ops, routing, SharePoint finds	Riley or Alex
Customer Support	support@example.com	support@ / info@ drafts; signup priority	Sam
Accounting AI Employee	accounting-bot@example.com	Receipts, vendor chase (internal)	Morgan
Helper capacity	helper@example.com	Desktop / overflow the lead assigns	Lead AI Employee or Alex

Clear lanes. An accounting helper does not sit in the support room answering customers. A helper does not email vendors without the lead or Morgan.

Standup format (example)

When	Channel	Who posts
Weekday morning (e.g. 09:00 America/Chicago)	AI Employee Squad Teams channel	Each AI Employee: 3 lines
Weekday afternoon (e.g. 15:00)	Same channel	Each AI Employee: 3 lines

Three-line standup (per AI Employee)

1. Done — what finished since last standup.
2. Doing — open AE- jobs / blockers.
3. Need — human ask (Sam / Morgan / Alex) or “none.”

Lead norms

Name a lead (often the Internal Ops AI Employee). Domain stay-in-lane. No invented executive approval. Helpers do not contact external parties without the lead or named human manager. One standup channel — do not add every helper to every room.

13. Example blueprints

Copy one blueprint per AI Employee. Do not run three lanes on one UPN.

13.1 Internal Ops AI Employee

Field	Value
Display name	Ops AI Employee
UPN	bot@example.com
Manager	Riley — Ops
Customer-facing	No
Watches	ops@example.com (confirm shared mailbox vs Group); Teams DMs from the allowlist
Graph	Core (section 4.1)
Gate	None for internal. Still no external send without Alex or Riley saying yes.
Allowlist	Alex, Jordan, Sam, Casey, Riley
Does	Status pulls, file finds on allowed sites, draft internal notes, queue work, answer in-lane FAQs.
Does not	Customer email, payroll, licence changes, speaking for executives.
SharePoint	Allow-list of ops / company sites. Deny HR, payroll, finance.
How to find it	Teams → New chat → “Ops AI Employee” or bot@example.com

13.2 Customer Support AI Employee

Field	Value
Display name	Customer Support Team
UPN	support@example.com
Manager	Sam — Support lead
Customer-facing	Yes
Watches	support@example.com info@example.com (check Group vs shared mailbox); maybe
Graph	Core, plus Mail.Read.Shared / Mail.Send.Shared if Graph must open shared inboxes
Gate	Sam approves every customer / external send until templates are APPROVED. Then approved templates may send. Edge cases still escalate forever.
Allowlist	Sam, Casey, Alex
Does	Draft replies, first-response drafts, pull order status, file the thread.
Does not	Refunds, legal positions, public social posts, changing prices.
Tone card	Required. Short, plain, not salesy.
Templates	Keep in a templates/ folder. Status is DRAFT until Sam writes APPROVED.
How to find it	Teams → New chat → “Customer Support Team” or support@example.com

Graduate the gate in this order. Do not jump.

- 1. Manager approves every outbound.
- 2. Manager approves anything that is not an APPROVED template.
- 3. Edge cases still escalate. There is no “full auto on all customer mail” step in this kit.

13.3 Accounting AI Employee

Field	Value
Display name	Accounting AI Employee
UPN	accounting-bot@example.com
Manager	Morgan — Controller (example extra employee)
Customer-facing	No
Watches	ap@example.com or a receipts mailbox
Graph	Core, but SharePoint limited to finance sites Morgan names
Gate	Morgan for any vendor email. Never email a customer.
Allowlist	Morgan, Alex
Does	Code receipts, chase missing bills internally, draft payment packs for a human to approve.
Does not	Approve payments, move money, open HR files, give tax advice, sit in the support squad channel.
How to find it	Teams → New chat → “Accounting AI Employee” or accounting-bot@example.com

If you run more than one AI Employee

Name a lead (often the Internal Ops AI Employee) and a small standup channel. Clear lanes. Do not add every helper to every room.

Appendix A — Printable checklist

Print this page. One copy per AI Employee.

AI Employee display name	_____	UPN	_____@example.com
Manager	_____	Customer-facing	[] No [] Yes (gate on)
Date started	_____	Date live	_____

A. Decide

- ☐ Display name chosen
- ☐ UPN / mailbox chosen
- ☐ Lane written (owns / does not own)
- ☐ Human manager named
- ☐ Customer-facing yes/no recorded
- ☐ Shared mailboxes / groups listed, with type (shared vs Group)
- ☐ Other systems (CRM, dashboards) listed
- ☐ Squad membership decided

B. Licence and Entra

- ☐ Business Standard (or required SKU) seat available
- ☐ Partner inventory ordered / reassigned if needed; loser of seat documented
- ☐ User created in Entra / Microsoft 365 admin
- ☐ Licence assigned; mailbox exists
- ☐ Manager field set
- ☐ Temp password handed on screen only
- ☐ Password changed + MFA enrolled
- ☐ Password files wiped

C. Mail and Teams

- ☐ Outlook on the web sign-in as the new UPN
- ☐ Teams on the web sign-in as the new UPN
- ☐ Shared mailbox: Full Access + Send As or Group: member/owner + Send As
- ☐ Propagation confirmed (AI Employee sees the mailbox)
- ☐ Test mail to owner only
- ☐ Test Teams chat with owner
- ☐ Desktop Teams client not treated as required

D. Graph

- ☐ Entra public-client app approved for this UPN
- ☐ Dedicated MSAL cache path (this UPN only)
- ☐ Device-code login completed (human MFA)
- ☐ Helpers parameterized by cache path and UPN
- ☐ Smoke: /me returns this UPN
- ☐ Smoke: list mail
- ☐ Smoke: send mail to owner only
- ☐ Smoke: Teams send
- ☐ Smoke: shared mailbox (if granted)
- ☐ Routines pointed at Graph; web kept as fallback

E. AI host agent and routines

- ☐ Agent name / description / title include lane, UPN, manager, policy
- ☐ Squad channel only if needed
- ☐ Outlook intake routine (weekday hours, America/Chicago)
- ☐ Teams intake routine (same hours)
- ☐ Silent-if-idle encoded
- ☐ Large-group passivity encoded
- ☐ Approval gate encoded (if customer-facing)
- ☐ Allowlist encoded
- ☐ Tone card path encoded (if customer-facing)
- ☐ Lead audit of routine prompts

F. Docs and go-live

- ☐ Job folder brief
- ☐ Setup file on owner desktop
- ☐ Tone card (if customer-facing)
- ☐ Templates DRAFT → (later) APPROVED
- ☐ Org map / coworker card updated
- ☐ Staff told: search person / email, not Apps
- ☐ First allowlisted users invited (Casey, Riley, ...)
- ☐ coworkers/ index started (cards ≠ allowlist)
- ☐ job-allowlist.json has exact emails only
- ☐ jobs-queue.json ready; max substantial = 3
- ☐ SharePoint human-docs sites named; private state on host
- ☐ Squad / standup decided (or explicitly single AI Employee, no squad)

Sign-off

Role	Name	Date	Initials
Owner / sponsor (Alex)			
IT Admin (Jordan)			
AI Employee manager (Sam)			

Appendix B — Troubleshooting one-pager

Use this when something feels stuck. Most failures are licence, mailbox type, cache mix, or “looked under Apps.”

Symptom	Likely cause	What to do
Create-user form will not assign Business Standard (0 available / grey)	Partner-managed inventory, or no free seat	Order a seat from the licence partner, or reassign an unused seat. Document who lost it. Do not promise go-live until a seat exists.
“Full Access” is missing or fails	The address is an M365 Group, not a shared mailbox	Inspect type first. For a Group: member (and owner only if needed) + Send As.
AI Employee cannot see the shared inbox after grants	Propagation delay, or wrong UPN	Wait 5–15 minutes. Sign out/in on Outlook web. Confirm the grant is on this UPN.
Teams desktop on the host is blank or crashes	Linux / thin-host desktop client	Use Teams on the web and Outlook on the web, or Graph. Desktop is optional.
People cannot find the AI Employee	They looked under Teams Apps	Tell them: New chat → search display name or email. It is a person account.
Mail sends from the wrong mailbox / wrong AI Employee	Two UPNs shared one MSAL cache	Stop. Isolate caches (msal-token-cache-<slug>.bin). Re-login the affected UPN. Treat as an incident.
Graph login loops or /me is the wrong user	Cache mix, or device-code completed as a human admin	Completed MFA is not Jordan. bot@example.com
Web works; Graph 403 on mail or chat	Scope missing or admin consent missing	Jordan consents the core set (section 4.1). Re-login so the token picks up new scopes.
Graph 403 on a shared mailbox	Missing shared-mail scopes, or no Full Access / Send As	Fix Exchange rights first. Then add Mail.Read.Shared / Mail.Send.Shared if you need Graph.
Customer mail went out with no review	Gate not encoded, or templates treated as APPROVED while still DRAFT	Pause outbound. Sam reviews. Restore “ask manager before every customer send.”
AI Employee talks in a busy group chat unprompted	Large-group passivity not encoded	Rule: more than three people including the AI Employee → reply only when addressed.
“Route egress through this desktop” is grey	Host was not provisioned with an egress tunnel	Update the AI host computer first so the tunnel exists. Then enable. Do not fight the grey toggle.
MFA or device-code sits forever	Human not in the loop	Jordan or the host operator must complete the browser prompt. The AI Employee cannot finish MFA alone.
AI Employee ignores Casey or Riley	Not on the allowlist, or email does not match exactly	Allowlist is exact UPN match. Sam / Alex add them. No wildcards.
Second AI Employee “isn’t as good as the first”	First AI Employee is on Graph; second is web-only	Budget a Graph login day (Phase D). Web is fine for a pilot, not for volume.
Too many AI Employees in one channel	No lead, no lanes	Name a lead. One standup channel. Keep helpers out of rooms they do not serve.
AI Employee took work from someone “on a card” only	Card confused with allowlist	Cards ≠ permission. Add exact email to allowlist.
One dig starves every other chat	No concurrency cap / no yield	Max 3 substantial working; FIFO queue; 12–15 min time-box then checkpoint.
Humans cannot find the setup kit the AI Employee “finished”	Artifact only on private host disk	Copy human-facing Word/PDF to SharePoint or owner desktop (section 11).

Healthy AI Employee checks (five minutes)

What success looks like. Signed in as the employee UPN, a controlled test send lands From: that UPN, intake is quiet when idle, and customer lanes never skip the gate.

- 1. Outlook web + Teams web sign-in as the AI Employee UPN.
- 2. /me (if Graph is on) returns that same UPN.
- 3. Test send to Alex (or Sam) only — arrived From: the AI Employee.
- 4. Next intake run stays silent when nothing is new. That is success.
- 5. If customer-facing: a test draft appears for Sam, and nothing sends until yes.
- 6. Job ids (if used) follow AE-YYYYMMDD-NNN.

If you must turn it off

Jordan disables the Entra user (or revokes sessions and blocks sign-in). Remove mailbox grants. Leave the cache file in place until you confirm nothing else points at it, then delete that cache only.

Example values used in this kit

Fictional example.com addresses · swap in your real ones when you deploy.

Placeholder	Example fill
Example Co	Contoso Ltd
example.com	contoso.com
bot@example.com	bot@contoso.com
support@example.com	support@contoso.com
accounting-bot@example.com	accounting-bot@contoso.com
info@example.com	info@contoso.com
ops@example.com	ops@contoso.com
ap@example.com	ap@contoso.com
America/Chicago	America/Regina
Licence owner	Jordan or Finance
AI Employee Graph	AI Employee Graph (public client)
SharePoint site URL	https://example.sharepoint.com/sites/ops

e people used in this kit: Alex (COO), Jordan (M365 admin), Sam (Support lead), Casey (Sales), Riley (Ops), Morgan (Controller). Map to your real names when you deploy.